Fortnightly cetuximab + irinotecan

NCCP 00331 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Visits, access and care between treatments

Cetuximab and irinotecan on Day 1, repeated every 14 days while beneficial and tolerable. There is no Day 8 cetuximab visit and no fluorouracil home pump.

STEP 1

Before the first visit

Confirm the exact regimen, tests, medicines, emergency number and treatment goal. Ask whether a peripheral cannula or an existing line is appropriate; a port is not automatically required.

STEP 2

At the treatment unit

Fortnightly cetuximab infusion time is set from the dose and safe infusion rate; the first dose may take longer. Irinotecan usually takes about 90 minutes. Blood review, preparation, premedicines and observation add time; infusion time is not the total appointment length.

STEP 3

After the infusion

There is no fluorouracil home pump and no disconnection visit in this regimen.

STEP 4

Between doses

Use the written symptom and support plan; do not wait for the next appointment if urgent symptoms appear.

STEP 5

The next decision

Confirm the next visit after any delay or dose change. Treatment continues only while the oncology team judges benefit and tolerability acceptable. Follow-up mineral checks continue after the final EGFR-antibody dose where applicable.

Transport and daily life

Plan transport if antihistamines, symptoms or other medicines affect driving. Ask for practical, work, nutrition or emotional support.

If treatment changes

Ask which component has been held and which visits remain. A treatment delay does not automatically cancel blood tests, line care or symptom follow-up.

Sources: NCCP 00331 v7 · official regimen. Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.